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POWER SYSTEM CONTROLLER FAILSAFE CYCLING PROTECTION

Abstract

Examples provide a method and system for inhibiting aircraft electrical power system controller failsafe state cycling in air mode condition. The electrical power system controller can include a bus power control unit (BPCU) or a generator control unit (GCU). A failsafe cycling protection indicator, such as a software flag or hardware electronic latch has a first configuration to indicate failsafe cycling protection is enabled and a second configuration to indicate failsafe cycling protection is disabled. An internal low voltage power source generates an output voltage. If a monitor component monitoring the output voltage detects an undervoltage or overvoltage, the aircraft electrical power system controller goes into a failsafe state. A failsafe cycling component prevents the aircraft electrical power system controller from exiting the failsafe state if the failsafe cycling protection is enabled.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/399,757, filed Aug. 11, 2021, which claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/064,397, entitled “POWER SYSTEM CONTROLLER FAILSAFE CYCLING PROTECTION,” filed on Aug. 11, 2020, the contents of which are incorporated herein by reference in their entireties.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Aircraft electrical power system controllers, such as, but not limited to, a bus power control unit (BPCU) and/or a generator control unit (GCU), regulate and distribute power around aircraft. As a form of protection, software and hardware circuitry within the electrical power system controller monitors the low voltage power supply (LVPS) output voltages and reacts to undervoltage and overvoltage conditions of any LVPS output by shutting down the controller to a failsafe state. The failsafe state is a shutdown or sleep/dormant state, in which the controller is no longer operating in normal mode. The failsafe state may also be referred to as failsafe mode, sleep mode, or a non-operational mode. Controllers recover from the failsafe state by monitoring for a manually initiated action, such as a specific flight deck switch actuation or cycling of the input power to the controller.

[0003] In some systems, automatic recovery from the failsafe state can occur in a controller if the fault is intermittent and low voltage output recovers, which looks like a controller recovery without any flight deck switch actuation or removal of the input power to the LVPS. This can result in the controller attempting to recover from failsafe without a manual operation, such as flight deck action. Frequent and random cycling of a controller into and out of the failsafe state due to LVPS output voltage toggling inside and outside of the failsafe trigger threshold band can potentially result in undesirable power loss of varying duration and frequency to power buses and downstream load equipment, as well as possible random duration of voltage transients.

SUMMARY

[0004] The disclosed examples are described in detail below with reference to the accompanying drawing figures listed below. The following summary is provided to illustrate implementations disclosed herein. It is not meant, however, to limit all examples to any particular configuration or sequence of operations.

[0005] Some aspects and implementations disclosed herein are directed at an electrical power system controller. The controller includes a failsafe cycling protection indicator indicating whether failsafe cycling protection is enabled or disabled. A low voltage power source (LVPS) generates an output voltage. If the output voltage falls outside an acceptable threshold range, the controller switches from a normal operating state to a failsafe state. A failsafe cycling component prevents the controller from returning to the operating state from the failsafe state at power up if the controller detects the aircraft is in air mode and failsafe cycling protection is enabled.

[0006] The features, functions, and advantages that have been discussed are achieved independently in various implementations or are to be combined in yet other implementations, further details of which are seen with reference to the following description and drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0007] FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating an aircraft including power system controller cycling protection according to an implementation.

[0008] FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating a set of controllers associated with a set of generator control units having anti-cycling protection according to an implementation.

[0009] FIG. 3 is a block diagram illustrating an aircraft electrical power system controller according to an implementation.

[0010] FIG. 4 is a block diagram illustrating a flag indicating enablement of failsafe cycling protection in an aircraft electrical power system controller according to an implementation.

[0011] FIG. 5 is a block diagram illustrating a failsafe cycling protection indicator including a parameter in non-volatile memory according to an implementation.

[0012] FIG. 6 is a block diagram illustrating a failsafe cycling protection indicator including a hardware electronic latch according to an implementation.

[0013] FIG. 7 is a block diagram illustrating a failsafe cycling protection indicator including a counter according to an implementation.

[0014] FIG. 8 is a block diagram illustrating a hardware interlock for failsafe cycling protection according to an implementation.

[0015] FIG. 9 is a block diagram illustrating an auxiliary GCU anti-cycling protection function according to an implementation.

[0016] FIG. 10 is a block diagram illustrating a bus power control unit (BPCU) anticycling protection function according to an implementation.

[0017] FIG. 11 is a block diagram illustrating a generator control unit (GCU) anticycling protection function according to an implementation.

[0018] FIG. 12 is a flow chart illustrating an implementation of a failsafe cycling component for engaging failsafe cycling protection.

[0019] FIG. 13 is a flow chart illustrating an implementation of a failsafe cycling component inhibiting failsafe cycling in air mode.

[0020] FIG. 14 is a flow chart illustrating an implementation of a failsafe cycling component providing anti-cycling protection.

[0021] FIG. 15 is a flow chart illustrating an implementation of a failsafe cycling component enabling return to an operating state.

[0022] FIG. 16 is a schematic perspective view of an aircraft according to an implementation.

[0023] FIG. 17 is an exploded view of the aircraft of FIG. 16.

[0024] Corresponding reference characters indicate corresponding parts throughout the drawings.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0025] The various implementations will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings. Wherever possible, the same reference numbers will be used throughout the drawings to refer to the same or like parts. References made throughout this disclosure relating to specific implementations and implementations are provided solely for illustrative purposes but, unless indicated to the contrary, are not meant to limit all implementations.

[0026] The foregoing summary, as well as the following detailed description of certain implementations will be better understood when read in conjunction with the appended drawings. As used herein, an element or step recited in the singular and preceded by the word “a” or “an” should be understood as not necessarily excluding the plural of the elements or steps. Further, references to “one implementation” are not intended to be interpreted as excluding the existence of additional implementations that also incorporate the recited features. Moreover, unless explicitly stated to the contrary, implementations “comprising” or “having” an element or a plurality of

elements having a particular property could include additional elements not having that property.

[0027] Various examples will now be described in connection with an aircraft electrical power system controller having an internal power supply with multiple internal operating voltages. Undervoltage and overvoltage is monitored based on hysteresis to shut-down the controller into a failsafe state and keep the controller shut down due to hard voltage regulation failures.

[0028] Hysteresis levels associated with the undervoltage/overvoltage protection react to allow the controller, such as a bus power control unit (BPCU) or generator control unit (GCU) to enter into and recover out of a failsafe state. As a result, automatic recovery occurs if the fault is intermittent and low voltage output recovers, without any flight deck switch actuation or removal of the 28 Volt (V) direct current (dc) input power to the power system controller. This allows for random and frequent cycling of a BPCU or GCU into and out of a failsafe state, for LVPS failure modes that result in the output voltage toggling inside and outside of the hysteresis band. The present disclosure provides additional protections when using undervoltage/overvoltage hysteresis thresholds to prevent failsafe cycling with respect to possible intermittent failure modes of an LVPS.

[0029] In other words, with the examples described herein, the controller LVPS protections do not assume a hard failure based on the above discussed conditions, but instead an intermittent fault. The systems and methods described herein monitor and consider other factors in addition to a voltage threshold to make a decision to enter into or recover from failsafe. As a result, failure modes associated with intermittent faults of the LVPS do not result in un-intended recovery of the BPCU and GCU from a failsafe state, without manual action. That is, the BPCU or GCU recover from a failsafe state by an actual power cycling and/or a manual action taken by the flight crew or a maintenance technician on the ground (button push on flight deck).

[0030] One or more output voltages of the LVPS can toggle between a normal operating range and a failsafe shutdown threshold randomly and possibly multiple times within a short period (e.g., such as many times in an airplane flight leg). This can result in the entire BPCU or GCU entering in and out of a failsafe state. The airplane system level result of a BPCU or GCU toggling in and out of a failsafe state can result in unpredictable and undesirable effects causing multiple power interrupts to aircraft electrical buses of varying duration and with random intervals between successive interrupts.

[0031] Some examples described herein provide a failsafe cycling protection component that is implemented as part of the power-up sequence of the affected electrical power system controllers. The failsafe cycling protection allows recovery of airplane electrical power system controllers in a deterministic and predictable manner which prevents on and off cycling behavior that would otherwise lead to out-of-tolerance system behavior and anomalous performance by aircraft load equipment.

[0032] Other examples provide a failsafe cycling component implemented within the BPCU and GCU software, to prevent undesirable cycling or toggling behavior in and out of a failsafe state. The failsafe cycling component only allows BPCU or GCU recovery from a failsafe state in a predictable and intentional manner. The method is designed to inhibit cycling behavior while the airplane is in an air mode condition, thereby preventing undesirable airplane level effects. The failsafe cycling component allows the power cycling behavior when the aircraft is on the ground, so as to prevent creating new issues with regular airplane troubleshooting and maintenance activities that involve turning on and off power to BPCU/GCU controllers.

[0033] In some examples, an internal parameter recorded in the non-volatile (internal) memory (NVM) indicates whether failsafe cycling protection should be enabled when the controller powers up. The term “power up” or “powers up” refers to the power or voltage level within the controller falling within an acceptable threshold range. The failsafe cycling protection utilizes information from internal memory and direct monitored input signals. In this manner, the system does not rely on coordination or communication with outside equipment or systems. This reduces network usage,

ensures reliance on high fidelity information, and improves efficiency of anti-cycling behavior. [0034] In other examples, the failsafe cycling protection is enabled when the airplane is in an air mode or engines are running. This prevents the anti-cycling protection from causing nuisance issues with troubleshooting fault messages or installation of new controllers with maintenance operations during airplane production or in service on the ground.

[0035] The failsafe cycling component, in still other examples, prevents failsafe cycling of controllers without a hardware design change to the controllers (BPCU or GCU). This results in a substantial cost savings over a hardware re-design for the BPCU and GCU.

[0036] In addition, the failsafe cycling component does not impact the normal power-up time of the BPCU/GCU and prevents a BPCU or GCU from unpredictably powering up in-flight without a manual user action, such as by a pilot, flight crew or maintenance technician. The failsafe cycling component is also flexible to ensure a controller can be installed during maintenance without adding any new power-up procedures. This ensures a known and predictable response to a controller with any issue that results in a failsafe condition during flight.

[0037] Referring more particularly to the drawings, FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating an aircraft **100** including power system controller cycling protection. The aircraft **100** can be implemented as any type of aircraft. For example, but without limitation, the aircraft **100** can include a fixed wing, rotary wing, or lighter-than-air aircraft. The aircraft **100** can be configured for carrying passengers, cargo, both passengers and cargo, or can be used for performing any other operation or mission. The aircraft **100** can be operated by an airline, a military unit, or any other private or governmental entity.

[0038] The aircraft **100**, in one example, includes a power system **102** having a set of one or more generators **104** and a set of one or more controllers **106**. The set of controllers **106**, in some examples, includes a set of bus power control units **108** and/or a set of GCUs **110**. The failsafe cycling component, in other examples, includes software for controlling electrical components on the aircraft **100**.

[0039] The set of generators **104** are driven by operation of the engines of aircraft **100**. For example, but without limitation, the set of generators **104** can generate power which is carried by feeder lines to aircraft electrical power controllers for distribution and conversion. The aircraft electrical power system controllers convert the power provided by the set of generators to electrical power for equipment loads and other functions on the aircraft **100**.

[0040] The BPCU and GCU are electrical power system controllers on the aircraft **100** responsible for keeping electrical buses powered with various source configurations and in a manner that conforms to power quality requirements, such as, with respect to voltage transients, interrupts, and dead bus times. When a BPCU or GCU has an internal failure, the BPCU or GCU may not be able to continue to perform in an acceptable manner. Each controller is designed to recognize internal errors and shutdown in a predictable manner into the failsafe state.

[0041] The set of BPCUs **108** in some examples includes one or more BPCUs, such as, but not limited to, the BPCU **112**. Each BPCU in the set of BPCUs **108** includes a failsafe cycling component **114** to prevent failsafe cycling. The set of GCUs **110** includes one or more GCUs, such as, but not limited to, GCU **116**. Each GCU in the set of GCUs **110** includes a failsafe cycling component **118** for preventing the GCU from cycling in and out of failsafe state.

[0042] The failsafe cycling component **114** or **118**, in some examples, includes software logic integrated into the power-up sequence of the BPCU **112** and GCU **116** to determine if it is acceptable to start operating and managing power. The failsafe cycling component **114** or **118**, in other examples, utilizes a software latch/flag that checks for conditions indicating servicing, aircraft in-flight and/or manual activation of control switches on the flight deck. The failsafe cycling component **114** or **118** prevents some controllers from restarting after entering failsafe state under certain conditions to prevent random failsafe cycling during aircraft flight (air mode).

[0043] The failsafe cycling component **114** or **118**, in some examples, creates a parameter written

to the controller internal memory that decides to enable the protection function, as well as the logic which allows for the controller to recover from a failsafe state based on manual action or appropriate ground conditions.

[0044] The set of controllers **106** provides power of multiple voltage types to a set of electrical power buses **120**. The set of electrical buses **120** provide power to a set of one more loads **122** associated with the aircraft **100**. The loads **122** can include any electrical device or system on the aircraft **100** that uses electrical power.

[0045] In some examples, the failsafe cycling component **114** or **118** prevents a controller from switching out of the failsafe state and back into normal operating state during flight. The operating state is the state in which the controller is operating within normal parameters or otherwise performing the controller functions as expected. The operating state includes a condition in which internal power of the controller is within an acceptable threshold range, without overvoltage or undervoltage. The operating state may also be referred to as the normal operating state, operating mode, operational state, operational mode, active mode, awake mode, or functional mode.

[0046] In other examples, the failsafe cycling component **114** or **118** permits the controller to exit the failsafe state and return to a normal operating state if a manual action is detected, such as, but not limited to, activation of at least one control switch in a set of control switches **124** by a member of the flight crew **126**. The set of control switches **124** includes one or more physical switches on the flight deck **128**, such as, but not limited to, a generator control switch **130** and/or an external power switch **132**. In some non-limiting examples, the flight deck switch(es) are switches that have a direct input to the associated power system controller.

[0047] The flight deck **128** also can be referred to as the cockpit of aircraft **100**. The flight deck can optionally include various controls which enable flight crew **126** to control the operation of aircraft **100**. The flight crew **126** can include a pilot, a co-pilot, a navigator, other personnel, or various combinations of personnel for controlling the operation of aircraft **100**.

[0048] In still other examples, the failsafe cycling component **114** or **118** permits a given controller to exit out of failsafe state if a set of generator control breakers **134** associated with the set of generators **104** is detected in an open configuration **136**. During flight (air mode), the set of generator control breakers **134** remain in a closed configuration **138**.

[0049] In this manner, the failsafe cycling component **114** or **118** prevents intermittent failure in the LVPS from causing a controller to enter failsafe state and then power up (return to normal operating state) many times in random sequence during flight. The intermittent failure can occur when the controller internal power supply intermittently fails when the voltage falls outside an acceptable voltage threshold range triggering failsafe (sleep) mode and then returns to normal operational mode when the voltage returns to a value within the threshold range. The controller mis-interprets this sequence of events as going through a power cycle (on and off power cycle) if the low voltage power supply drops out, such as an undervoltage below a threshold value and/or an overvoltage above a threshold value and then returns to a value within the acceptable threshold range. That is, the un-deterministic behavior can be caused by how a power cycle is determined to have occurred. The failsafe cycling protection ensures deterministic behavior, while avoiding random false power cycles.

[0050] FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating a set of controllers **106** associated with a set of generator control units having anti-cycling protection. In some examples, the aircraft **100** includes a set of two engines. Each engine is associated with a pair of generators. The engine **202** is associated with a generator **204** and a generator **206**. The engine **208** is associated with a generator **210** and a generator **212**.

[0051] An auxiliary power unit **218**, in other examples, includes a set of one or more generators. In this example, the auxiliary power unit **218** includes a first generator **214** and a second generator **216**.

[0052] Each generator on the aircraft **100** is associated with a generator control unit in the set of

controllers **106**. Each controller in the set of controllers **106** includes anti-cycling protection **220**. In one example, the set of controllers includes six GCUs. The GCUs **222** and **224** are associated with the generators for the engine **202**. The GCUs **226** and **228** are associated with the pair of generators for the engine **208**. The auxiliary GCUs **230** and **232** are associated with the auxiliary generators **214** and **216**. The GCUs **222**, **224**, **226**, **228**, **230** and/or **232** may be a controller, such as, but not limited to, the GCU **116** in FIG. **1**.

[0053] The set of controllers **106**, in some examples, can also include one or more BPCUs, such as, but not limited to, the BPCU **118** in FIG. **1**. In other examples, the aircraft **100** includes two BPCUs (not shown).

[0054] The aircraft **100**, in this non-limiting example, includes four engine fed generators on a twin-engine configuration that are primarily operating in-flight with two generators per engine. The aircraft **100** also has two large generators on the auxiliary power unit. The auxiliary engines do not normally operate during flight. Each generator has a dedicated GCU (e.g., the GCU **116**) responsible for regulating the power of a corresponding generator and coordinating with other GCUs **116** to apply power to various electrical buses on the aircraft **100**. In this example, as described herein, the aircraft **100** includes a set of six GCUs **116** performing functions including power transfer, control of power and regulation of power.

[0055] In one example, the aircraft **100** also includes two bus power control units that act as redundant controllers located in the forward of the aircraft **100**. These controllers are primarily responsible for communicating with the aircraft data system to feed information to all other controllers and act in concert/junction with the GCUs to regulate power flow to buses on the aircraft **100** as well. The controllers allow power on and off to the forward buses on the forward part of the aircraft **100**, which are lower voltage, such as 115 and 28 volts.

[0056] The GCUs **116** receive power separately from corresponding generators. The GCUs **116** are basically digital circuit controllers with microprocessors and low-level circuitry. The GCUs require an internal power supply to perform one or more functions. The GCUs have a common part therein, namely a low voltage power supply that receives 28 volts direct current (Vdc) and creates lower level voltages to supply various circuitry and electronics cards in order to perform its required functions within the power system controller.

[0057] If the low voltage power supply has a problem, the problem is recognized and the failsafe state is entered, with power shut off. For example, if there is a short circuit inside the low voltage power supply and the controller can no longer support the voltages needed on an output, the controller goes into failsafe state and thereby shuts itself down. The failsafe cycling component on each GCU **116** and BPCU **112** enables the system to react in a controlled and deterministic manner without interrupting the flow of power to the various buses on the aircraft **100**.

[0058] FIG. **3** is a block diagram illustrating an aircraft electrical power system controller **300**. The aircraft electrical power system controller **300** is a controller associated with a generator, such as, but not limited to, the set of controllers **106** in FIG. **1** and FIG. **2**. The aircraft electrical power system controller **300** can include a BPCU, such as, but not limited to, the BPCU **112** in FIG. **1**. The aircraft electrical power system controller **300** can also include a GCU associated with a generator, such as, but not limited to, the GCU **116** in FIG. **1**.

[0059] A failsafe cycling protection indicator **302** is configured to indicate whether failsafe cycling protection is enabled within a given controller. In some examples, the failsafe cycling protection indicator **302** is implemented as a parameter or flag within non-volatile memory. In other examples, the failsafe cycling protection indicator **302** is implemented as a physical latch on or within the controller. In still other examples, the failsafe cycling protection indicator **302** includes a counter having a value which indicates whether anticycling protection is enabled.

[0060] In one example, the failsafe cycling protection indicator **302** includes a first configuration **304** indicating the failsafe cycling protection is enabled **306**. A second configuration **308** indicates the failsafe cycling protection is disabled **310**. Failsafe cycling protection is enabled during flight

and disabled during maintenance when the aircraft is on the ground. Thus, normal maintenance practices with the BPCU **112** and GCU **116** on the ground are not changed. The failsafe cycling prevents undesirable cycling behavior in-flight. Removing this undesirable behavior enables an aircraft electrical power system to switch into and out of failsafe state with improved operating characteristics.

[0061] A low voltage power supply (LVPS) **312** on the aircraft electrical power system controller **300** generates an output voltage **314** that is used internally within the controller **300** to supply circuitry and electronics cards. A monitor component **316** monitors the output voltage **314** to ensure the voltage output by the LVPS **312** is within an acceptable voltage threshold range **318** (e.g., a defined operating range).

[0062] The acceptable voltage threshold range **318** optionally includes a minimum threshold **320** and a maximum threshold **322**. If the output voltage exceeds the maximum threshold **322** an overvoltage is indicated. If the output voltage **314** falls below the minimum threshold **320**, the LVPS output voltage **314** is indicated as an undervoltage.

[0063] If the output voltage **314** is an overvoltage or an undervoltage, the aircraft electrical power system controller **300** exits a normal operating state **330** and enters a failsafe state **332**. During the failsafe state **332**, the aircraft electrical power system controller **300** ceases regulating and controlling power to one or more buses.

[0064] One type of internal failure that can result in shutdown to a failsafe state **332** is due to issues/faults associated with the internal low voltage power supply. Each BPCU **112** and GCU **116** operates internal circuitry from one or more low voltages, such as 5V, 3.3V, +15V and -15V outputs supplied by the LVPS.

[0065] A failsafe cycling component **326** determines whether the aircraft **100** is in air mode or is on the ground based on analysis of monitor data **324**. The monitor data **324** is data associated with the operating frequency of generators and/or generator breaker state data **334** indicating whether generator circuit breakers are open or closed. The generator circuit breakers include any device that disconnects a bus from a generator when the generator circuit breaker is in the open configuration.

[0066] If the monitor data **324** indicates air mode and failsafe cycling protection is enabled **306**, the failsafe cycling component **326** does not permit the aircraft electrical power system controller **300** to leave the failsafe state without manual action.

[0067] The manual action, in some examples, includes control switch activation **336**. Control switch activation **336** refers to manual activation of one or more physical control switches associated with the flight deck of the aircraft **100**, such as, but not limited to, the set of control switches **124** in FIG. **1**. In lieu of manual action, generator circuit breaker status may also be sensed to determine operating state **330** is allowed. This alternative to manual action enables the controller to leave failsafe state by sensing that both engines are off (an on-ground state) via sensing the state of generator circuit breakers as open. This may occur, for example, during maintenance on the aircraft. The on-ground state refers to the aircraft on the ground as opposed to being in-flight.

[0068] FIG. **4** is a block diagram illustrating a flag **402** indicating enablement of failsafe cycling protection in the aircraft electrical power system controller **300**. The flag **402** is a parameter or indicator in memory **404** indicating whether the failsafe cycling protection is enabled or disabled. In some examples, if failsafe cycling protection is enabled, the flag **402** is set to true.

[0069] The monitor component **316**, in some examples, monitors an output voltage generated by the LVPS **312**. If the monitor component **316** detects an over voltage **416** or an undervoltage **418**, while the aircraft is in air mode **408** and the failsafe cycling protection is enabled, the aircraft electrical power system controller **300** remains in failsafe state until a manual action is detected and/or the aircraft returns to ground mode **410**.

[0070] In some examples, the aircraft electrical power system controller **300** includes one or more processors, such as, but not limited to, the processor **406**. The processor **406** includes any quantity

of processing units and is programmed to execute the computer-executable instructions.

[0071] The failsafe cycling component **420**, in some examples, is a software component executed by the processor **406** to inhibit the aircraft electrical power system controller **300** from cycling in and out of failsafe state during air mode. The failsafe cycling component **420** analyzes monitor data in other examples to determine whether to prevent the aircraft electrical power system controller **300** from exiting failsafe state without manual action.

[0072] The memory **404**, in some examples, is implemented as a computer readable media or other data storage device. By way of example and not limitation, computer readable media comprise computer storage media and communication media. Computer storage media include volatile and nonvolatile, removable, and non-removable memory implemented in any method or technology for storage of information such as computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules, or the like. Computer storage media are tangible and mutually exclusive to communication media. Computer storage media are implemented in hardware and exclude carrier waves and propagated signals. Computer storage media for purposes of this disclosure are not signals per se.

[0073] In one implementation, computer storage media include hard disks, flash drives, solid-state memory, phase change random-access memory (PRAM), static random-access memory (SRAM), dynamic random-access memory (DRAM), other types of random-access memory (RAM), read-only memory (ROM), electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM), flash memory or other memory technology, compact disk read-only memory (CD-ROM), digital versatile disks (DVD) or other optical storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other non-transmission medium used to store information for access by a computing device. In contrast, communication media typically embody computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules, or the like in a modulated data signal such as a carrier wave or other transport mechanism and include any information delivery media.

[0074] FIG. 5 is a block diagram illustrating a failsafe cycling protection indicator including a parameter in non-volatile memory. The controller **500**, in this example, is an aircraft electrical power system controller, such as, but not limited to, a controller in the set of controllers **106** in FIG. 1 and/or the aircraft electrical power system controller **300** in FIG. 3.

[0075] In this example, a parameter **502** in non-volatile memory (NVM) **504** indicates whether failsafe cycling protection is enabled. The parameter **502** is a failsafe cycling protection indicator, such as, but not limited to, the failsafe cycling protection indicator **302** in FIG. 3 and/or the flag **402** in FIG. 4.

[0076] In a first configuration **506**, the parameter **502** indicates failsafe cycling protection is enabled **508** if the parameter has a value of true **510**. A second configuration **512** of the parameter **502** indicates failsafe cycling protection is disabled **514** if the value is set to false **516**.

[0077] In some non-limiting examples, the parameter **502** is an internal variable in NV-RAM that latches to indicate if failsafe cycling protection variable should be enabled. The failsafe cycling protection is active when the aircraft **100** is in the air (not on the ground) and the engines are running.

[0078] FIG. 6 is a block diagram illustrating a failsafe cycling protection indicator including a hardware electronic latch **602**. The controller **600**, in this example, is an aircraft electrical power system controller, such as, but not limited to, a controller in the set of controllers **106** in FIG. 1 and/or the aircraft electrical power system controller **300** in FIG. 3.

[0079] The hardware electronic latch **602** is an electronic latching that when triggered, will set and maintain an output signal until it is reset. When the hardware electronic latch **602** on the controller **600** is in a set state **604**, the failsafe cycling component **420** providing failsafe cycling protection is enabled **606**. In the reset state **608**, the failsafe cycling protection is disabled **610**. In some examples, the latch **602** latches a controller in failsafe until a manual action is taken on the ground by maintenance personnel.

[0080] FIG. 7 is a block diagram illustrating a failsafe cycling protection indicator including a counter. The controller **700** in this example is an aircraft electrical power system controller, such as, but not limited to, a controller in the set of controllers **106** in FIG. 1 and/or the aircraft electrical power system controller **300** in FIG. 3.

[0081] The counter **702** in memory **704** on the controller **700** has a value **706**. The value can be incremented **710** by the failsafe cycling component **708** or reset **712**. The value **706**, in some examples, indicates whether failsafe cycling protection is enabled or disabled.

[0082] In some non-limiting examples, the counter is incremented by the failsafe cycling component based on transition to engine start (for the GCU **116**) or actions of a ground handling relay (for the BPCU **112**). The counter value **706** is reset to an original value or zero counter value based on the transition to engine shutdown (for the GCU **116**) or transition to air mode (for the BPCU **112**). The counter incrementing above a certain value is assessed when the controller powers up to determine if the controller is allowed to exit from the failsafe state.

[0083] FIG. 8 is a block diagram illustrating a hardware interlock for failsafe cycling protection. In this example, the LVPS **802** generates a voltage output that is monitored by a monitor component **808** associated with aircraft **100**. The monitor component **808** activates a low going signal that causes the processor **806** to be in reset and triggers the electronic latch **804** to a “set” state. The electronic latch **804** maintains the latched state as long as the 28V input **810** sources are continuous. The output of the electronic latch **804** is a signal input to the processor **806**, such that if the LVPS **802** spontaneously is restored, and the processor **806** executes power up routines, there is programmed logic that prevents the processor **806** from completing power up and go immediately into the failsafe state. Once in the ‘set’ state, the electronic latch **804** can be ‘reset’ by removing and re-applying the 28V input **810** source power, or by momentarily activating the flight deck controller switch **812**. In this manner, the failsafe state is not reset until the system determines that all 28 Vdc power inputs ceased and were restored.

[0084] FIG. 9 is a block diagram illustrating an auxiliary GCU anti-cycling protection function at **900**. In some examples, if the controller detects air mode and at least one generator (left engine or right engine generator) outputting at more than 400 Hz while the APU is running at **902**, the controller enables failsafe cycling protection at **904**. If the controller enters failsafe state for any reason at **906**, the GCU does not return to the normal operating state until the generator control switch (GCS) transitions from on to off or from off to on via a manual activation of the physical switch in the flight deck. Once failure reason is corrected, the GCU returns to the normal operating state when the designated flight deck switch depressed at **908**.

[0085] In other examples, if the output of a generator monitored on each engine or the output of both generators is less than 400 Hz, indicating the generators are turned off or when the aircraft is out of flight mode **910**, the failsafe cycling protection is disabled at **912**. If the controller enters failsafe state for any reason **914** once failure reason is corrected, the GCU returns to normal operational state with designated flight deck switch depressed or power cycle **916**.

[0086] In some examples, the auxiliary GCU failsafe cycling protection method is enabled with a parameter written to internal NVM if the auxiliary GCU detects the air mode, at least one generator speed is greater than 400 Hz, and an auxiliary power unit (APU) ready-to-load parameter is true (i.e., APU is running).

[0087] The auxiliary GCU has some scenarios where automatic recovery in air mode is allowed. These scenarios are allowed if the APU is not running in-air. Additionally, the auxiliary GCU does not impact normal bus power sources when the APU is not already running. Therefore, this condition does not require limitations unless the APU is operating.

[0088] Failsafe cycling protection, in other examples, is disabled if the aircraft **100** is not in air mode or the system determines that both engines are not running (monitor one generator speed per engine). If the auxiliary GCU **116** powers up when controller power levels (voltage) are detected within an acceptable threshold range with the failsafe cycling protection enabled (or true), the GCU

116 remains in the failsafe state and does not recover from the failsafe state by returning to the normal operational state until the associated flight deck switch, such as a generator control switch on the flight deck, is activated. The flight deck switch can be activated when the switch is selected from on to off or from off to on position by the user. In other examples, the switch is activated when the user presses or depresses the switch.

[0089] FIG. **10** is a block diagram illustrating a BPCU anticycling protection function. When the failsafe cycling protection is disabled **1002** and the BPCU **112** enters the failsafe state for any reason **1004**, the BPCU returns to normal operating state (leaves failsafe state) with manual activation of a control switch or power cycle returning the output voltage of the LVPS to a voltage within the acceptable threshold range once the failure reason is corrected at **1006**.

[0090] If an air mode is detected and at least one generator (left engine generator or right engine generator) operates above defined levels. For example, at 400 hertz (Hz) or greater at **1008**, the failsafe cycling protection is enabled at **1010**. When enabled, if the BPCU **112** enters the failsafe state for any reason **1012**, the BPCU **112** does not exit failsafe state until a physical switch is manually depressed or a power cycle occurs with at least one generator circuit breaker open in a configuration at **1014**.

[0091] Thus, once the failure reason is corrected, the BPCU will return to operational state (come alive) with designated flight deck switch depressed or left engine or right engine GCB sensed as open with power cycle detection.

[0092] In some examples, if the aircraft **100** is not in the air mode or both generators (L**1** and R**1**) operate at less than 400 Hz at **1016**, the failsafe cycling protection is disabled at **1002**. It should be appreciated that other frequency values can be used. In these examples, if both generators are essentially off (i.e. generator frequency is low), it indicates the corresponding engines associated with those off-line generators are also off, based on data available within the controller (when it is not in failsafe and communicating with other system controllers).

[0093] Thus, in some examples, BPCU failsafe cycling protection is enabled with a parameter written to internal NVM when the BPCU **112** detects air mode and at least one generator speed is greater than 400 Hz. The BPCU **112** does not utilize air mode alone to determine whether to exit the failsafe state due to certain maintenance functions and installation of new controllers to the aircraft **100**, which may have an air mode status recorded in memory while the aircraft **100** is on the ground.

[0094] In other examples, failsafe cycling protection is disabled if the aircraft **100** is not in air mode or all generator speeds are less than 400 Hz indicating the aircraft engines are off. If the BPCU **112** powers up with the failsafe cycling protection enabled (flag is true), the BPCU **112** does not recover from the failsafe state until its associated external power switch (physical button) is depressed on the flight deck or the controller power-up with either a left engine or right engine GCB senses as open (which does not occur in-flight).

[0095] In other examples, when the BPCU **112** detects the air mode and at least one generator (left engine generator or right engine generator) operates above defined levels (i.e. above 400 Hz), the system writes a flag (parameter) into internal NVM that indicates that if the controller goes into failsafe state and then powers up, the controller is not allowed to come online unless the aircraft is not in-flight. The controller can determine the aircraft is not in-flight if one generator circuit breaker is open or at least one generator is offline, which would not be the expected state of generator circuit breakers during flight.

[0096] Thus, in some examples, both the left and right engines are shut down or ground mode is detected before the BPCU **112** is allowed to return to the normal operating state when the controller powers up (power within the acceptable threshold range) after a power cycle. Thus, if the aircraft is detected in either ground mode or both engines are detected in shutdown, the BPCU is permitted to return to normal operational state out of failsafe state when the voltage again falls within the acceptable threshold value after power cycle. This ensures the aircraft **100** is on the ground prior to

the BPCU failsafe cycle occurring.

[0097] FIG. **11** is a block diagram illustrating a GCU anticycling protection function **1000**. In some examples, if the controller detects the air mode and at least one generator (left engine or right engine generator) is outputting at more than 400 Hz at **1102**, the controller enables failsafe cycling protection at **1104**. If the controller enters failsafe state for any reason at **1106**, the GCU does not switch to operating state until an associated/appropriate flight deck switch is actuated per pilot procedure at **1108**.

[0098] In other examples, if the aircraft **100** is not in air mode or the output of both generators is less than 400 Hz, indicating the generators are turned off, at **1110**, the failsafe cycling protection is disabled at **1112**. If the controller enters failsafe state for any reason at **1114** while the failsafe cycling protection is disabled, the controller (GCU **116**) returns to normal operating state after a power cycle or activation (depression) of a designated flight deck switch at **1116**.

[0099] The main GCU failsafe cycling protection method is enabled in some examples when a flag (parameter) written to internal NVM is set to true, and the main GCU detects the air mode and a generator speed of at least one generator is greater than 400 Hz.

[0100] Thus, the main GCU does not utilize air mode alone to determine whether to exit failsafe state due to certain maintenance functions and installation of new controllers to the airplane, which can have an air mode status recorded in memory while the aircraft **100** is on the ground.

[0101] In other examples, failsafe cycling protection within the main GCU is disabled when the aircraft **100** is not in air mode or a determination is made that both engines are shut down. In other words, this is used to determine that both engines are not running. This determination can be made based on operational state of the corresponding generators associated with the engines. If the main GCU powers up with the failsafe cycling protection enabled (or true), the GCU does not recover (exit) from the failsafe state until the associated generator control switch on the flight deck is activated. Activation of the switch can occur when the switch state is toggled from on to off or from off to on or when the switch is depressed via button push or other switch activation mechanism.

[0102] FIG. **12** is a flow chart **1200** illustrating an implementation of a failsafe cycling component for engaging failsafe cycling protection. In one implementation, the operations illustrated in FIG. **12** are performed, at least in part, by executing instructions by the one or more processors, such as, but not limited to, the processor **406** in FIG. **4**.

[0103] At operation **1202**, the controller determines if the aircraft is in air mode. If yes, a determination is made whether both generators have a speed less than 400 Hz at operation **1204**. If yes, failsafe cycling protection is disengaged at operation **1212**.

[0104] A determination is made whether the controller is an auxiliary GCU at **1206**. If yes, a determination is made whether an auxiliary power unit (APU) is operating at operation **1208**. If the controller is a BPCU/GCU, the system does not determine if the APU is operating. Returning to **1208**, if the APU is operating, failsafe cycling protection is engaged at operation **1210**. The process terminates thereafter.

[0105] FIG. **13** is a flow chart **1300** illustrating an implementation of a failsafe cycling component inhibiting failsafe cycling in air mode. In one implementation, the operations illustrated in FIG. **13** are performed, at least in part, by executing instructions by the one or more processors, such as, but not limited to, the processor **406** in FIG. **4**.

[0106] It should be noted that the present disclosure can be implemented in connection with any controller for a power system, such as any controller for an aircraft power system bus. In some examples, the herein described systems and methods are operable with a generator, a source controller, and/or a bus controller, among others.

[0107] At operation **1302**, the controller powers up after entering a failsafe state. A determination is made whether failsafe cycling protection is enabled at operation **1304**. If yes, a determination is made whether manual action is detected at operation **1306**. If no, a determination is made whether

either GCBs are open at operation **1308**. If no, the controller remains in failsafe state at operation **1310**. The process remains in failsafe state and continues monitoring for manual action at **1306** and/or monitors for an indication either GCB is in an open configuration at **1308**. until manual action is detected or indication that both GCBs are open (one GCB associated with each engine is monitored). When manual action, such as flight deck switch activation is detected at **1306** or either GCBs are in open configuration at **1308**, the controller exits failsafe state at operation **1312**.

[0108] If the failsafe cycling protection is not enabled at **1304**, the controller exits failsafe state and returns to normal operating state at operation **1312**. The process terminates thereafter.

[0109] Thus, in some examples, if a controller powers up out of failsafe state, the controller checks the parameter which is internally recorded to determine whether failsafe cycling protection has been enabled—as an initial determinator to decide whether to exit the failsafe state. After that, the controller looks for a flight deck button push or status of GCBs (for the BPCU) to determine when to exit a failsafe state.

[0110] FIG. **14** is a flow chart **1400** illustrating an implementation of a failsafe cycling component providing anti-cycling protection. In one implementation, the operations illustrated in FIG. **14** are performed, at least in part, by executing instructions by the one or more processors, such as, but not limited to, the processor **406** in FIG. **4**.

[0111] At operation **1402**, output voltage is monitored by a monitor component on the controller. A determination is made whether the output voltage is within a threshold at operation **1404**. If no, the controller switches to failsafe state at operation **1406**. Monitor data is analyzed at operation **1408**. A determination is made whether the voltage returns to a value within a user-configurable threshold range at operation **1410**. If yes, the failsafe cycling component remains in the failsafe state at operation **1412**. The controller is preventing from returning to the operating state at operation **1414**. The process terminates thereafter.

[0112] FIG. **15** is a flow chart **1500** illustrating an implementation of a failsafe cycling component enabling return to an operating state. In one implementation, the operations illustrated in FIG. **15** are performed, at least in part, by executing instructions by the one or more processors, such as, but not limited to, the processor **406** in FIG. **4**.

[0113] At operation **1502**, a failsafe cycling protection indicator is checked at power-up of the controller to determine whether failsafe cycling protection is enabled at operation **1504**. If yes, the BPCU enters failsafe state at operation **1506**. A determination is made whether a control switch is activated at operation **1510**. If yes, the failsafe cycling component enables the BPCU to return to operating state at operation **1514**.

[0114] If a control switch is not manually activated at operation **1510**, a determination is made whether a generator circuit breaker (GCB) is open at operation **1512**. If yes, the BPCU is enabled to return to operating state at operation **1514**. The process terminates thereafter.

[0115] If the manual control switch is not activated and the circuit breakers are not open at operation **1512**, the BPCU remains in the failsafe state at operation **1514**. The system iteratively checks for manual activation of the control switch at **1510** and/or an indication a GCB is open at **1512**. When manual control switch activation and/or a GCB(s) open, the system exits failsafe state and returns to operating state at **1514**. The process terminates thereafter.

[0116] With reference now to FIG. **16**, a more specific diagram of an aircraft **1600** is depicted in which an implementation of the disclosure is advantageously employed. In this example, the aircraft **1600** includes an airframe **1602** with a plurality of systems **1604** and an interior **1606**. Implementations of the plurality of systems **1604** include one or more of a propulsion system **1608**, an electrical system **1610**, a hydraulic system **1612**, and an environmental system **1614**. However, other systems are also candidates for inclusion. Although an aerospace example is shown, different advantageous implementations are applied to other industries, such as the automotive industry, etc.

[0117] FIG. **17** is an exploded view of the aircraft **1600**. The section **1702** of the aircraft **1600** is a forward section of including a set of BPCUs. In some examples, the forward section includes two

BPCUs. The section **1704** includes a set of GCUs. In this example, the set of GCUs in the section **1704** includes six GCUs in which each GCU is associated with a generator.

[0118] The implementations disclosed herein are described in the general context of computer code or machine-useable instructions, including computer-executable instructions such as program components, being executed by a computer or other machine, such as a controller. Generally, program components including routines, programs, objects, components, data structures, and the like, refer to code that performs particular tasks, or implement particular abstract data types. The disclosed implementations are practiced in a variety of system configurations, including personal computers, laptops, smart phones, mobile tablets, hand-held devices, consumer electronics, specialty computing devices, etc. The disclosed implementations are also practiced in distributed computing environments, where tasks are performed by remote-processing devices that are linked through a communications network.

[0119] The illustrations of FIG. 1, FIG. 2, FIG. 3, FIG. 4, FIG. 5, FIG. 6, FIG. 7, FIG. 8, FIG. 9, FIG. 10, FIG. 11, FIG. 12, FIG. 13, FIG. 14, FIG. 15, FIG. 16, and FIG. 17 are not meant to imply physical or architectural limitations to the manner in which different illustrative embodiments may be implemented. Other components in addition to, in place of, or both in addition to and in place of the ones illustrated may be used. Some components may be unnecessary in some illustrative embodiments. Also, the blocks are presented to illustrate some functional components. One or more of these blocks may be combined or divided into different blocks when implemented in different illustrative embodiments.

[0120] Thus, various examples prevent improper power cycle turn on and turn off of a power supply when the aircraft **100** is in the air. That is, the present disclosure prevents indeterministic behavior, namely preventing a controller from improperly detecting that the power supply has gone through a proper power cycle.

[0121] The following paragraphs describe further aspects of the disclosure:

[0122] A1. A system for failsafe cycling protection, the system comprising: [0123] an aircraft electrical power system controller comprising a computer-readable medium storing instructions that are operative upon execution by a processor to: [0124] switch from an operating state to a failsafe state responsive to detection of output voltage from a low voltage power source of the aircraft electrical power system controller outside an acceptable voltage threshold range, wherein the output voltage outside the acceptable threshold range indicates an undervoltage or an overvoltage; [0125] inhibit the aircraft electrical power system controller returning to the operating state from the failsafe state at power up responsive to a failsafe cycling protection enabled; and [0126] enable the aircraft electrical power system controller to return to the operating state from the failsafe state responsive to a manual activation of a control switch on a flight deck or detection of a set of generator control breakers in an open configuration.

[0127] A2. The system of claim **1**, further comprising: [0128] an internal flag in non-volatile memory, wherein the internal flag is set to a first configuration to indicate failsafe cycling protection is enabled, wherein the internal flag is set to a second configuration to indicate failsafe cycling protection is disabled.

[0129] A3. The system of claim **1**, further comprising: [0130] a hardware electronic latch, wherein failsafe cycling protection is enabled when the latch is in a set state, and wherein failsafe cycling protection is disabled when the latch is in a reset state.

[0131] A4. The system of claim **1**, further comprising: [0132] a counter value stored in a non-volatile memory on the aircraft electrical power system controller, wherein a failsafe cycling component determines whether to permit the aircraft electrical power system controller to switch from the failsafe state to the operating state based on the counter value.

[0133] A5. The system of claim **1**, wherein the instructions are further operative to: [0134] enable failsafe cycling protection of the aircraft electrical power system controller when a failsafe cycling component associated with the aircraft electrical power system controller detects air mode and a

generator speed of at least one generator exceeds 400 Hz.

[0135] A6. The system of claim **1**, wherein the aircraft electrical power system controller is a BPCU, and wherein the instructions are further operative to: [0136] enable the BPCU to exit the failsafe state and return to the operating state responsive to activation of a forward external power switch or power-up with a first generator control breaker or a second generator control breaker in an open configuration.

[0137] A7. The system of claim **1**, wherein the aircraft electrical power system controller is an auxiliary GCU, and wherein the instructions are further operative to: [0138] enable failsafe cycling protection of the GCU with a parameter written to internal NVM responsive to a failsafe cycling component associated with the GCU detects air mode, a generator speed of at least one generator exceeds 400 Hz and the auxiliary power unit (APU) associated with the GCU operating.

[0139] A8. A method of failsafe cycling protection, the method comprising: [0140] switching, by a failsafe cycling component, an aircraft electrical power system controller from an operating state to a failsafe state responsive to detection of output voltage from a low voltage power source of the aircraft electrical power system controller outside an acceptable voltage threshold range, wherein the output voltage outside the acceptable threshold range indicates an undervoltage or an overvoltage; [0141] preventing return to the operating state when failsafe cycling protection is enabled; and [0142] enabling the aircraft electrical power system controller to return to the operating state from the failsafe state responsive to detecting a manual activation of a control switch on a flight deck or detection of a set of generator control breakers in an open configuration.

[0143] A9. The method of claim **8**, further comprising: [0144] setting an internal flag in non-volatile memory to a first configuration to indicate failsafe cycling protection is enabled, wherein the internal flag is set to a second configuration to indicate failsafe cycling protection is disabled.

[0145] A10. The method of claim **8**, further comprising: [0146] engaging a hardware electronic latch in a set state to enable failsafe cycling protection, and wherein failsafe cycling protection is disabled when the latch is in a reset state.

[0147] A11. The method of claim **8**, further comprising: [0148] monitoring a failsafe cycling parameter indicating whether failsafe cycling protection is enabled; and [0149] preventing the controller from exiting failsafe state based on a value of the failsafe cycling parameter.

[0150] A12. The method of claim **8**, wherein the aircraft electrical power system controller is a BPCU, and further comprising: [0151] permitting the BPCU to exit the failsafe state and return to the operating state responsive to detecting activation of a forward external power switch.

[0152] A13. The method of claim **8**, wherein the aircraft electrical power system controller is a BPCU, and further comprising: [0153] permitting the BPCU to exit the failsafe state and return to the operating state responsive to detecting a first generator control breaker and a second generator control breaker in an open configuration.

[0154] A14. The method of claim **8**, further comprising: [0155] enabling failsafe cycling protection of the aircraft electrical power system controller with a parameter written to internal NVM responsive to detecting an air mode of an aircraft associated with the aircraft electrical power system controller, a generator speed of at least one generator exceeds 400 Hz, and the auxiliary power unit (APU) associated with the GCU is activated.

[0156] A15. The method of claim **8**, wherein the aircraft electrical power system controller is a GCU, and further comprising: [0157] detecting a manual activation of a generator power switch associated with a flight deck; and [0158] returning the GCU to the operating state from the failsafe state.

[0159] A16. An electrical power system controller, further comprising: [0160] a failsafe cycling protection indicator having a first configuration to indicate failsafe cycling protection is enabled and a second configuration to indicate failsafe cycling protection is disabled; [0161] an internal low voltage power source generates an output voltage; [0162] a monitor component switches the electrical power system controller from an operating state to a failsafe state responsive to detection

of the low voltage power source generating the output voltage outside an acceptable voltage threshold range, wherein the output voltage outside the acceptable threshold range indicates an undervoltage or an overvoltage; and [0163] a failsafe cycling component, implemented on at least one processor, inhibits the aircraft electrical power system controller returning to the operating state from the failsafe state at power up responsive to failsafe cycling protection enabled.

[0164] A17. The electrical power system controller of claim **16**, wherein the failsafe cycling protection indicator is a parameter in NVM.

[0165] A18. The electrical power system controller of claim **16**, wherein the failsafe cycling protection indicator is a hardware electronic latch.

[0166] A19. The electrical power system controller of claim **16**, wherein the failsafe cycling protection indicator comprises a counter in NVM on the aircraft electrical power system controller, and further comprising: [0167] a counter value stored in the counter, wherein a failsafe cycling component determines whether to permit the aircraft electrical power system controller to switch from the failsafe state to the operating state based on the counter value.

[0168] A20. The electrical power system controller of claim **16**, further comprising: [0169] a failsafe cycling component that permits the aircraft electrical power system controllers to exit the failsafe state and return to the operating state responsive to manual activation of a control switch associated with a flight deck.

[0170] When introducing elements of aspects of the disclosure or the implementations thereof, the articles “a,” “an,” “the,” and “said” are intended to mean that there are one or more of the elements. The terms “comprising,” “including,” and “having” are intended to be inclusive and mean that there could be additional elements other than the listed elements. The term “implementation” is intended to mean “an example of.” The phrase “one or more of the following: A, B, and C” means “at least one of A and/or at least one of B and/or at least one of C.”

[0171] Having described aspects of the disclosure in detail, it will be apparent that modifications and variations are possible without departing from the scope of aspects of the disclosure as defined in the appended claims. As various changes could be made in the above constructions, products, and methods without departing from the scope of aspects of the disclosure, it is intended that all matter contained in the above description and shown in the accompanying drawings shall be interpreted as illustrative and not in a limiting sense.

Claims

1. A system, comprising: an aircraft electrical power system controller comprising a computer-readable medium storing instructions that are operative upon execution by a processor to: switch from an operating state to a failsafe state based on detection of an output voltage, from a low voltage power source of the aircraft electrical power system controller, outside of an acceptable voltage range; inhibit, based on a failsafe cycling protection being enabled, the aircraft electrical power system controller from returning to the operating state from the failsafe state at power up, wherein the failsafe cycling protection is based on an assumption of an intermittent failure in the low voltage power source; and cause the aircraft electrical power system controller to return to the operating state, from the failsafe state, based on a manual input, a detection of an on-ground state, or a counter value.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein the manual input comprises an activation of a control switch on a flight deck.
3. The system of claim 1, wherein detection of the on-ground state comprises a detection that engines, of an aircraft associated with the aircraft electrical power system controller, are off.
4. The system of claim 3, wherein the instructions are further operative upon execution by the processor to: sense that a set of generator control breakers are in an open state, wherein the engines are detected as being off based on the set of generator control breakers being in the open state.

5. The system of claim 1, wherein the counter value indicates whether the failsafe cycling protection is enabled.
6. The system of claim 1, wherein the counter value is incremented based on an engine start or based on actions associated with a ground handling relay.
7. The system of claim 1, wherein the counter value is reset based on an engine shutdown or a transition to an air mode.
8. The system of claim 1, wherein the instructions, to cause the aircraft electrical power system controller to return to the operating state, are operative upon execution by the processor to: determine whether to permit the aircraft electrical power system controller to switch from the failsafe state to the operating state based on the counter value.
9. The system of claim 1, further comprising: a flag, in a non-volatile memory, that indicates whether the failsafe cycling protection is enabled; or a latch that indicates whether the failsafe cycling protection is enabled.
10. A method, comprising: switching, by a failsafe cycling component, an aircraft electrical power system controller from an operating state to a failsafe state based on detection of an output voltage, from a low voltage power source of the aircraft electrical power system controller, outside of an acceptable voltage range; preventing, by the failsafe cycling component, return to the operating state based on a failsafe cycling protection being enabled, wherein the failsafe cycling protection is based on an assumption of an intermittent failure in the low voltage power source; and causing, by the failsafe cycling component, the aircraft electrical power system controller to return to the operating state, from the failsafe state, based on a manual input, a detection of an on-ground state, or a counter value.
11. The method of claim 10, wherein the manual input comprises an activation of a control switch on a flight deck.
12. The method of claim 10, wherein detection of the on-ground state comprises a detection that engines, of an aircraft associated with the aircraft electrical power system controller, are off.
13. The method of claim 12, further comprising: sensing that a set of generator control breakers are in an open state, wherein the engines are detected as being off based on the set of generator control breakers being in the open state.
14. The method of claim 10, wherein the counter value indicates whether the failsafe cycling protection is enabled.
15. The method of claim 10, wherein causing the aircraft electrical power system controller to return to the operating state comprises: determining whether to permit the aircraft electrical power system controller to switch from the failsafe state to the operating state based on the counter value.
16. An aircraft electrical power system controller comprising: a low voltage power source operable to generate an output voltage; a monitor component operable to switch the aircraft electrical power system controller from an operating state to a failsafe state based on detection of the output voltage outside of an acceptable voltage range; and a failsafe cycling component, implemented using at least one processor, operable to inhibit, based on a failsafe cycling protection being enabled, the aircraft electrical power system controller from returning to the operating state from the failsafe state at power up, wherein the failsafe cycling protection is based on an assumption of an intermittent failure in the low voltage power source.
17. The aircraft electrical power system controller of claim 16, wherein the low voltage power source is further operable to receive a low voltage current and create one or more lower level voltages to supply circuitry.
18. The aircraft electrical power system controller of claim 16, wherein the failsafe cycling component is further operable to: cause the aircraft electrical power system controller to return to the operating state, from the failsafe state, based on a manual input, a detection of an on-ground state, or a counter value.
19. The aircraft electrical power system controller of claim 18, wherein the manual input comprises

an activation of a control switch on a flight deck.

20. The aircraft electrical power system controller of claim 18, wherein detection of the on-ground state comprises a detection that engines, of an aircraft associated with the aircraft electrical power system controller, are off.
